Business Plan Template · Expert version

A business plan template gives you a proven structure for describing your business, market, strategy, operations and finances, so you can raise money, align partners or simply think clearly about where the business is going.

How to use this template

1. Start with the Financials tab: rough numbers early show whether the idea works.
2. Work through each section on the Business plan tab, writing short, specific answers.
3. Write the executive summary last, once everything else is clear.
4. Assign an owner to each section if several people are contributing, and use the Status column to track progress.
5. Ask someone outside the business to read it and challenge your assumptions.
6. Export to PDF or copy the answers into a formatted document when you share it with investors or lenders.

Tips

• Keep the plan short: investors often read only the summary and financials.
• Back up market claims with sources and realistic numbers.
• Show the assumptions behind every projection.
• Update the plan at least once a year or when strategy changes.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	Founder	1
Status	Not started	12
Status	In progress	0
Status	On hold	0
Status	Blocked	0
Status	Done	0

Business plan · Work through each section and track progress

Section	What to cover	Your answer	Owner	Status
1. Executive summary	The business in one page: problem, solution, target customers, why now, financial headline and the ask.		Founder	Not started
2. Company description	Mission, legal structure, location, founders and stage of the business.			Not started
3. Problem and solution	The customer problem, how you solve it and why your solution is better than alternatives.			Not started
4. Market analysis	Target segments, market size (TAM/SAM/SOM), trends and customer needs.			Not started
5. Competition	Direct and indirect competitors, their strengths and weaknesses, and your advantage.			Not started
6. Products and services	What you sell, pricing, product roadmap and intellectual property.			Not started
7. Marketing and sales	Positioning, channels, sales process, customer acquisition cost and retention.			Not started
8. Operations	Suppliers, facilities, technology, key processes and milestones.			Not started
9. Team and management	Founders, key hires, advisers and the organisation chart.			Not started
10. Financial plan	Revenue model, 3-year projections, break-even point and key assumptions (see Financials tab).			Not started
11. Funding request	How much you need, what it will be used for and the expected return for investors.			Not started
12. Appendix	Supporting documents: CVs, market research, permits, contracts.			Not started

Financials · Three-year profit and loss projection: edit the figures and totals recalculate

Line item	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Notes
Revenue	120,000	210,000	340,000	Units sold x average price
Cost of goods sold	48,000	80,000	122,000	
Gross profit	72,000	130,000	218,000	Calculated
Salaries	60,000	95,000	140,000	
Marketing	15,000	25,000	35,000	
Rent and utilities	12,000	12,500	13,000	
Other operating costs	8,000	10,000	12,000	
Operating profit	-23,000	-12,500	18,000	Calculated